

Qilin Zhang

University of Florida
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Citizenship: China
Marital Status: Married

Placement Director: Ignacia Mercadal, imercadal@ufl.edu

Education

University of Florida

Ph.D. Economics

Expected 2027

University of Wisconsin – Madison

M.S. Economics

2022

Shanghai University of Finance and Economics

Bachelor of Management in Labor and Social Security

2019

Fields

Primary: Macroeconomics

Secondary: Public Economics, Family Economics, Chinese Economy

Job Market Paper

Gender-biased Dynastic Savings and the Marriage Market: Evidence from China

This paper studies how parents' investments in their children shape the marriage market in China. Using household survey data, I document that the marriage market is assortative and the parents' investment mix differs by child gender. In a dynastic model of parental investment and marriage matching, I find that gender-biased investment lowers the marriage rate: removing the gender gap in the cost of education raises it by 1.85 percentage points. As parents grow richer with China's growth, the model explains 35 percent of the fall in the crude marriage rate between 2010 and 2024 and predicts a further decline. Subsidies to newlyweds raise marriage, whereas equal-sized transfers to parents lower it.

Working Papers

A Micro Anatomy of the Hidden Local Government Debt in China: 2014–2023

Presented at the Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting, 2025

Work in Progress

Mass Layoffs and Fertility: Evidence from WARN-Based Shocks – with Yuchen Zhu

Residential Mobility and Household Consumption – with Yanqi Li

Selected Presentations

Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting

2025

Research Experience

Research Assistant to Min Fang, University of Florida	Summer 2023
Research Assistant to Germán Bet, University of Florida	Spring – Fall 2023
Research Assistant to Perihan Saygin, University of Florida	Fall 2022

Teaching Experience

University of Florida

Instructor of Record: Managerial Economics (Undergraduate)	Spring 2026 – Present
<i>Student evaluations (Spring 2026, 83.9% response): enthusiasm 4.54/5; communication and availability 4.65/5</i>	
TA: Macroeconomic Theory (Ph.D.; led weekly discussion section)	Fall 2024
TA: Computational Economics (Ph.D.)	Spring 2025
TA: Macroeconomic Analysis (Master's)	Spring 2025
TA: International Macroeconomics (Master's)	Fall 2022
TA: Intermediate Macroeconomics (Undergraduate)	Spring 2023, Summer 2024
TA: Managerial Economics, Economic Data Analysis (Undergraduate); Game Theory Applied (MBA)	Spring 2024

University of Wisconsin – Madison

TA: Economics of Poverty & Inequality (Undergraduate)	Spring 2022
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Awards and Honors

University Fellowship, University of Florida	2022 – Present
China National University Student Innovation & Entrepreneurship Dev. Program Grant	2018
Shanghai Education Bureau Research Grant	2017

Skills

Programming: MATLAB, Python, R, Stata

References

Min Fang (Co-Chair) Department of Economics University of Florida min.fang.ur@gmail.com	Eugenio Rojas (Co-Chair) Department of Economics University of Florida erojasbarros@ufl.edu	Arthur Wickard Department of Economics University of Florida awickard@ufl.edu
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